

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

26th October, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

43rd WEEK



XI JINPING & CHINA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... INDIA AND ITS NEIGHBORHOOD- RELATIONS.



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

26th OCTOBER, 2017

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The life of Xi

The Communist Party Congress signals his growing power and China's ascendancy

When Xi Jinping was elected the leader of China and the Communist Party two years ago, many had predicted that he would become the most powerful leader since Deng Xiaoping, the architect of the country's economic rise. They may be wrong. With the fifth party congress, which concluded on Tuesday and has written his memoirs into the party constitution, Mr. Xi now appears to be the strongest leader since Mao Zedong. This amassing of Mao-like powers could also allow Mr. Xi to stay in power beyond the usual two terms. Two of Mr. Xi's predecessors had stepped down after two terms to ensure an orderly transition in the party and the government, where there is no written tradition of seniority leaders. The practice has been for the incumbent party congress to choose the likely successor of the incumbent and groom him over two years to eventually take over the reins. However, the party doesn't seem to have chosen anyone this time. All the members to the seven-member Politburo standing committee, the highest decision-making body in China, are in their 60s, which lends credence to speculation that Mr. Xi is not planning to step down when his second term ends in 2022, even if the clock stops down from the government, given the tenure he has already achieved within the party, he could retain a Deng-like sway over policy matters.

To Mr. Xi's world view, China has passed two eras: the revolutionary era launched by Mao and the economic reforms spearheaded by Deng. The Xi Jinping thought on socialism with Chinese characteristics for a New Era that has been written into the party charter marks "a new era". This one is about making China economically stronger and geopolitically more influential. In his three-and-a-half-hour evening address, Mr. Xi placed greater emphasis on strengthening the military and rejecting "the whole range of erroneous viewpoints". The message is that China's "great rise" is over. The name of the new foreign policy Mr. Xi's administration is pursuing will continue, perhaps more aggressively, while at home he will consolidate more power. But this doesn't mean it will be a cakewalk. If China takes a more aggressive, unilateral view of its neighbourhood, it could trigger an aggressive response from neighbours such as India and Japan. North Korea remains as much a foreign policy problem for Mr. Xi as for President Donald Trump. China's export-oriented economy is still not free from the global economic whirlwinds. Mr. Xi will have to factor in global market concerns while taking key economic decisions at home. Besides, though the transition in the Communist Party has been orderly at least in the last 30 years, it was not free from troubles. Mr. Xi would be mindful of how he projects his own power, lest it triggers a backlash. The challenge before him is to find a balance between his ambitions and the realities that China is confronting.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date : 26th October, 2017

5 The life of Xi

Date : 26th October, 2017

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The Communist Party Congress signals his growing power and China's assertiveness

When Xi Jinping was elected the leader of China and the Communist Party five years ago, many had predicted that he would become the most powerful leader since Deng Xiaoping, the architect of the country's economic rise. They may be wrong. With the 19th party congress, which concluded on Tuesday and has written his name and ideas into the party constitution, Mr. Xi now appears to be the strongest leader since Mao Zedong. This amassing of Mao-like powers could also allow Mr. Xi to stay in power beyond the usual two terms. Two of Mr. Xi's predecessors had stepped down after two terms to ensure an orderly transition in the party and the government, where there is no dearth of talented and ambitious leaders. The practice has been for the mid-term party congress to choose the likely successor of the incumbent and groom him over five years to eventually take over the reins. However, the party doesn't seem to have chosen anyone this time. All five new faces in the seven-member Politburo Standing Committee, the highest decision-making body in China, are in their 60s, which lends credence to speculation that Mr. Xi is not planning to step down when his second term ends in 2022. Even if he does step down from the government, given the stature he has already achieved within the party, he could retain a Deng-like sway over policy matters.

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5 The life of Xi

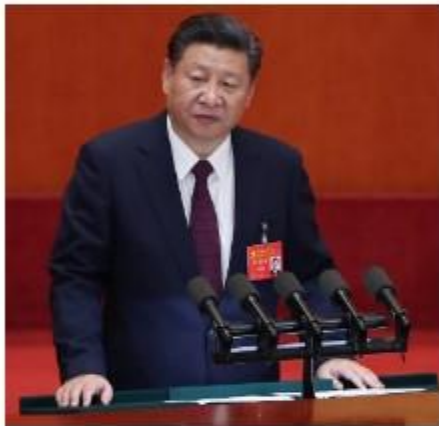
Date : 26th October, 2017

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In Mr. Xi's world view, China has passed two eras — the revolutionary era launched by Mao and the economic reforms spearheaded by Deng. The "Xi Jinping thought on socialism with Chinese characteristics for a New Era" that has been written into the party charter marks "a new era". This one is about making China economically stronger and geopolitically more influential. In his three-and-a-half-hour speech at the congress, Mr. Xi placed great emphasis on strengthening the military and resisting "the whole range of erroneous viewpoints". The message is that the era of "peaceful rise" is over. The more combative foreign policy Mr. Xi's administration is pursuing will continue, perhaps more aggressively, while at home he will consolidate more power. But this doesn't mean it will be a cakewalk. If China takes a more aggressive, militaristic view of its neighbourhood, it could trigger an aggressive response from neighbours such as India and Japan. North Korea remains as much a foreign policy problem for Mr. Xi as for President Donald Trump. China's export-oriented economy is still not free from the global economic whirlwinds. Mr. Xi will have to factor in global market concerns while taking key economic decisions at home. Besides, though the transition in the Communist Party has been orderly at least in the last 30 years, it was not free from troubles. Mr. Xi would be mindful of how he projects his own power, lest it triggers a backlash. The challenge before him is to find a balance between his ambitions and the realities that China confronts today.

RECENT NEWS ITEM

“China has entered a new era, where it should take centre stage in the World”, President Xi Jinping says.



Xi Jinping

President, China

The Congress enshrined "Xi Jinping Thought on Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era" to the party constitution as a guiding ideology

SALIENT POINTS

- The Country's rapid progress under socialism with Chinese characteristics shows there is "a new choice for other countries", Xi told the Communist Party Congress.
- The Congress takes place once every five years.
- More than 2,000 delegates attended the event.



MONGOLIA

CHINA

Sea of Japan

North Korea

South Korea

JAPAN

East China Sea

INDIA

NEPAL

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

VIETNAM

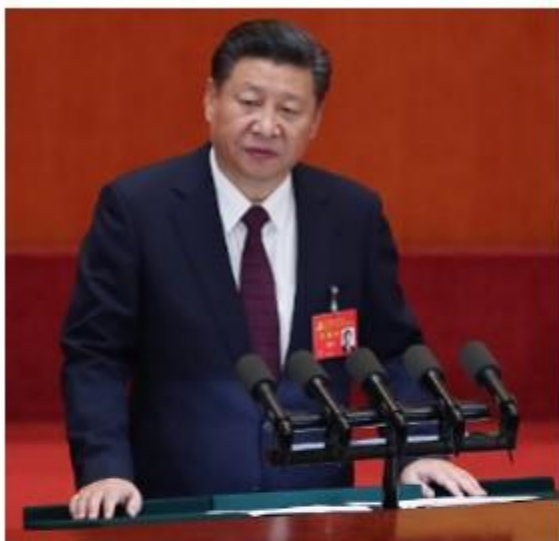
Lao PDR

RECENT NEWS ITEM



SALIENT POINTS

- Mr. Xi, in his three hour speech has listed China's recent achievements and said China has now become a great power in the World and had played an important role in the history of mankind.
- Mr. Xi Jinping said he would not copy foreign systems and that the Communist Party must oppose anything that would undermine the leadership of China.



Xi Jinping
President, China



KEY PRINCIPLES OF XI JINPING THEORY

- 1** Ensuring Party leadership in overall work areas.
- 2** Harmony between humans and nature.
- 3** Upholding absolute Party leadership over the people's Liberation Army.
- 4** Upholding the principle of one country-two systems and promoting national reunification, a reference to Hong Kong and Taiwan.
- 5** Exercising full and strict governance over the Party.



MONGOLIA

CHINA

HONG KONG

MACAU

North Korea

South Korea

JAPAN

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

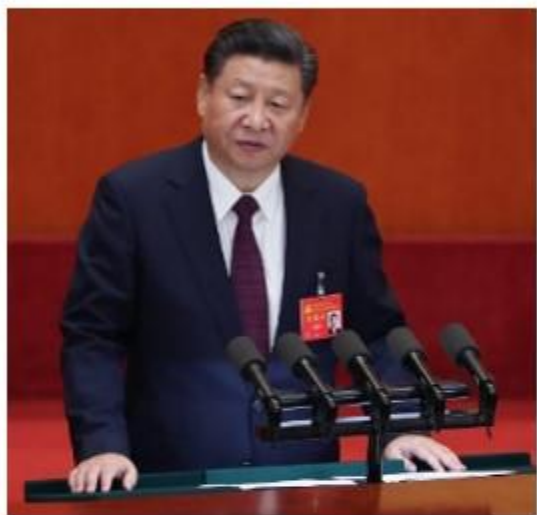
East China Sea

INDIA

NEPAL

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Lao PDR



Xi Jinping

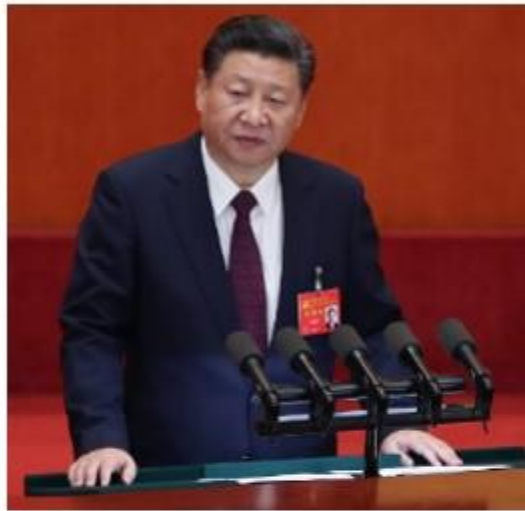


Mao Zedong



XI JINPING AND CHINA

- 1 Xi Jinping is now widely seen as the country's most powerful leader, since Mao Zedong, after the addition of his name and thoughts to the Party's Constitution.
- 2 Xi now carries multiple titles, President, Chairman of Military and Party's core leader and he is often called the Chairman of every thing.
- 3 He broke with the tradition, while naming members of the Country's top body by not anointing a clear successor.



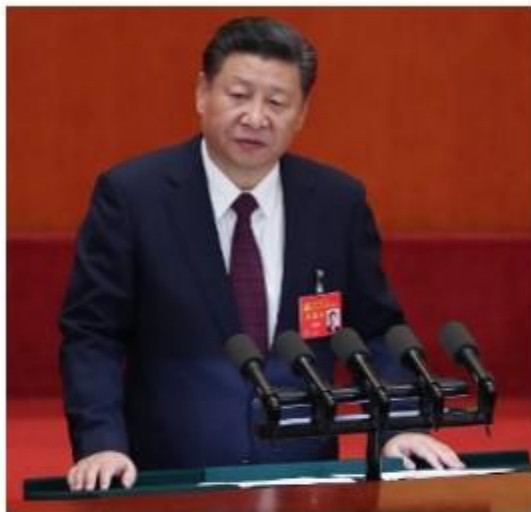
Xi Jinping
President, China

Xi Jinping appears to be the strongest leader since Mao Zedong.

CAN HE CONTINUE BEYOND TWO TERMS?

- 1 Two of Mr. Xi's predecessors had stepped down after two terms to ensure an orderly transition in the party and the Government.
- 2 The practice has been for the mid-term Party Congress to choose the likely successor of the present incumbent and groom him over five years to eventually take over the reins.
- 3 All five new faces in the seven-member Politburo Standing Committee, the highest decision-making body in China, are in their 60s and this gives credence to speculation that Mr. Xi is not planning to step down, when his second term ends in 2022.

Even if he steps down. He could retain a Deng Xiaoping like sway over policy matters.



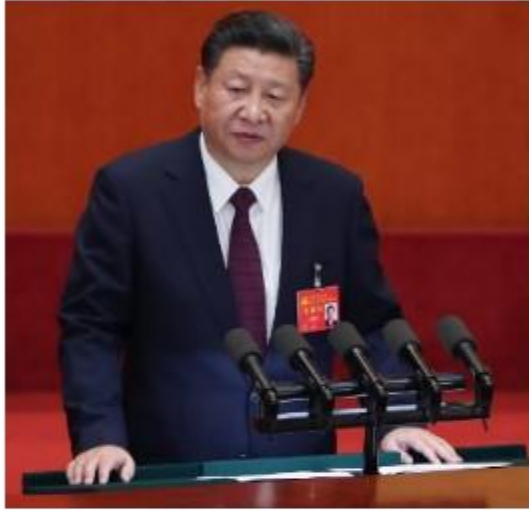
Xi Jinping



Deng Xiaoping

XI JINPING THOUGHT ON SOCIALISM WITH CHINESE CHARACTERISTICS

- 1** In Mr. Xi's World view, China has passed two eras. The revolutionary era was launched by Mao and the economic reforms spearheaded by Deng Xiaoping
- 2** Now, Mr. Xi thought on socialism with Chinese characteristics for a New Era has gone in to the party charter
- 3** This is about making China economically stronger and geopolitically more influential.



Xi Jinping



WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

- 1** The era of peaceful raise of China is over.
- 2** The more combative foreign policy will continue with more aggression. At home, he will consolidate more power.
- 3** He will further strengthen the military

Overall the position of Mr. Xi Jinping will be further strengthened as the time passes.



WHAT ARE THE MAIN PROBLEMS?

- 1 If China takes a more aggressive militaristic approach, this may trigger an aggressive response from countries like India and Japan
- 2 North Korea continues to be a foreign policy problem.
- 3 China's export oriented economy is still not free from the Global Economic whirlwinds.
- 4 China's high debt problem is another major issue.
- 5 Xi Jinping has to factor in global market concerns, while taking key economic decisions at home.

The challenge before him is to find a balance between his ambitions and the realities that China confronts today.

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